FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

RADIO WATCH

Procedure

MV SEAGULL | UVI: 425689

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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Role	Name	Date
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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This procedure establishes the radio watch and communication requirements for MV Seagull.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5). NSCV C7B (Communication Equipment). Radiocommunications Act 1992 (Cth).

2. RADIO EQUIPMENT

The vessel is fitted with the following communication equipment (NSCV C7B):

- Fixed-mount marine VHF radio.
- Handheld VHF radio (backup and for shore-side / dinghy operations).
- Signalling light.

3. RADIO WATCH REQUIREMENTS

- A continuous listening watch shall be maintained on VHF Channel 16 (156.800 MHz) at all times when the vessel is underway. In addition to Channel 16, the master shall monitor the VHF channel of the relevant port authority for the operational area. The applicable port authority channels are listed in Section 3.1 and 3.2 below and in the VHF Channel Quick Reference table in Section 5.

3.1 Sydney Harbour Operations

- Monitor VHF Ch 13 for Sydney VTS — commercial shipping movements, navigational warnings, and traffic management for Sydney Harbour.
- When operating in Commonwealth waters near Garden Island (Fleet Base East) and HMAS Waterhen, monitor and use VHF Ch 14 for Defence port operations.
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- Advise the relevant port authority when commencing or completing diving operations in harbour waters.

3.2 Botany Bay Operations

- Monitor 12 for Botany Bay VTS — traffic information and vessel movements for Botany Bay.

3.3 General

- The master or a crew member holding a Marine Radio Operator's Certificate of Proficiency (MROCP) or Marine VHF Radio Operator's Certificate shall be responsible for radio communications.
- If operating outside LCS/VHF coverage areas, an HF radio, satellite communication system, or satellite telephone is required (NSCV C7B). The current edition of the Marine Radio Operators Handbook shall also be carried.

4. DISTRESS, URGENCY, AND SAFETY CALLS

4.1 Distress (MAYDAY)

A MAYDAY call shall be made when the vessel or a person is in grave and imminent danger and requires immediate assistance. The format is:

- MAYDAY MAYDAY MAYDAY.
- This is Seagull Seagull Seagull.
- MAYDAY Seagull.
- My position is [latitude and longitude or bearing and distance from a known point].
- Nature of distress.
- Number of persons on board.
- Any other useful information (e.g. vessel description, assistance required).
- OVER.

4.2 Urgency (PAN PAN)

A PAN PAN call shall be made when the safety of the vessel or a person is threatened but there is no immediate danger to life. The format follows the same structure as MAYDAY but begins with PAN PAN PAN PAN PAN PAN.

4.3 Safety (SÉCURITÉ)

A SÉCURITÉ call shall be made to broadcast important navigational or meteorological warnings. This shall be used when commencing diving operations to warn other vessels of the vessel's position and operations.

5. VHF CHANNEL QUICK REFERENCE

Channel	Usage
VHF Ch 16	International distress, safety, and calling channel. Continuous listening watch required.
VHF Ch 13	Sydney VTS (Port Jackson) — commercial shipping movements and harbour traffic.
12	Botany Bay VTS — Botany Bay traffic information and vessel movements.
VHF Ch 14	Defence port operations — Garden Island Tower / Waterhen Tower.
VHF Ch 12 / 67 / 73	Botany Bay VTS; Marine Rescue NSW (Sydney / Botany Bay).

6. TRIP REPORTING

Before departure, the master shall log a trip report with Marine Rescue NSW (if operating in their area) or notify the East Coast Operations Superintendent, providing:

- Vessel name and UVI.
- Number of persons on board.
- Departure point and destination.
- Expected time of arrival.
- Communications schedule.

On arrival, the master shall close the trip report.

7. RECORDS

All distress, urgency, and safety communications are recorded in the vessel logbook with time, channel, and content summary.

8. REFERENCES

- NSCV C7B (Communication Equipment)
- AMSA Guidance Notice P200608 — NSCV C7 Class 2D Equipment Guide
- Radiocommunications Act 1992 (Cth)
- Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 11(5)
- AMSA Marine Radio Communications Handbook
- Marine Rescue NSW
- Sydney VTS